

Narayan Ashanahalli

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Interaction designer with architecture background bringing systems thinking to designing products and interactions. Skilled in visual design, research, and technical prototyping with 2+ years experience building products, developing strategies, and leading small teams through design and iteration.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Master of Advanced Architectural Design

Pittsburgh, PA

May 2026

Relevant Coursework: Designing AI Products, AI Augmented Designer, Introduction to Deep Learning, Building User-Centered Sensing Systems, Spatial Interaction Design, Customer Discovery for Tech Innovation

JNAFA University

Bachelor of Architecture

Hyderabad, IN

July 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

Design Researcher

December 2024 – Present

Lab 4 Cybernetics | Carnegie Mellon University

- Lead research assistant for newly established cybernetics lab: manage 3-person RA team, coordinate lab operations, and own product development for matching tools for 50+ practitioners and students.
- Implemented practitioner-student matching platform from intake flows to search interface; validated through testing with 25 early adopters across 3 departments.
- Launched knowledge management system converting 200+ nodes of cybernetics literature into structured repository with obsidian metadata architecture enabling concept navigation and search.

Project Designer

August 2023 – July 2024

Studio Chintala | Bangalore, India

- Led design strategy for Amara Raja's 7.5M sqft manufacturing campus: ran on-site employee research and developed spatial analysis methodology for first-time rural workforce needs.
- Analyzed industrial urbanism trends and existing conditions across five spatial systems: circulation, green infrastructure, wayfinding, workplace zones, and utilities.
- Proposed 4-phase implementation plan with cost-tiered solutions balancing operational constraints, starting with a \$10,000 Phase 1 pilot.
- Produced environmental graphics for Shell Corporation: executed 8'x8' interactive wayfinding installation and 400+ sqft of laser-cut acrylic branding across 6 employee break-rooms, serving 200+ daily users.

Machine Learning Intern

August 2020 – December 2020

Uniworks Design | Hyderabad, India

- Constructed training dataset for ArP-Gen GAN model: validated 2,000+ architectural floor plans with feature labels.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Product Designer | [Dot Threads](#)

Browser Extension for Knowledge Management

November 2025 – January 2026

- Designed and shipped browser extension exploring spatial approaches to knowledge management, currently live on Chrome Web Store with +10 active users.
- Shipped 4 click workflow and graph-based canvas for organizing web links by context and relationships.

Interaction Designer | Pointobot

August 2025 – Feb 2026

Interactive Structures Lab | CMU HCI

- Designed a camera-based task assistance system that reads physical workspace and user state, reasons about task progress, and delivers structured guidance (correct, clarify, or redirect).
- Developed an interaction framework mapping three input signals (object state, user actions, task state) to three intervention modes for physical assembly tasks.

Interaction Designer | [Piko](#)

Context-Aware Wearable Assistant

March 2025 – May 2025

- Developed a wearable system to detect phone usage with 91% accuracy and deliver behavior-based audio feedback.
- Prototyped a feedback system for CV pipeline detecting 6 gesture types and 3 posture cues using Raspberry Pi; contributed to real-time audio response logic adapting to user attention patterns and environmental context.

SKILLS

Design: User Research, Product Strategy, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Prototyping, Wireframing, Visual Design, Systems Thinking, Project Management, Data Visualization, Survey Design, Product Ownership

Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Suite, Framer, Sketch, Rhino 3D

Technical: HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React, TypeScript, Python, GitHub, API integration, AI-Assisted Prototyping